

Advanced Software Engineering

Course Syllabus & Roadmap — Fall 2026 (115-1)

Graduate Seminar (進階軟體工程)

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Course Overview & Philosophy

- **Core Methodologies & The Impact of AI:**
 - Master **foundational software engineering methodologies** across the complete lifecycle (specification, architecture, validation, evolution).
 - Explore how **Generative & Agentic AI** fundamentally impacts and reshapes every software activity.
- **Graduate–Level Pedagogy: Research & Empirical Practice:**
 - **Scholarly Exploration:** Investigate cutting–edge research topics and empirical studies through **paper presentations and panel discussions**.
 - **Hands–on Experimentation:** Experience software development directly through **practical implementation and empirical experiments**.
- **Key Course Attributes:**
 - **Target Audience:** Graduate students and motivated senior undergraduates.
 - **Language of Instruction:** English–friendly / bilingual materials.
 - **Interactive Pedagogy:** Concept Check Questions (CCQ) with real–time polling, architectural critiques, and collaborative discussions.

Course Learning Objectives (CLOs)

- **1. Master Core SE Disciplines:**
 - Understand lifecycles, requirements, OO modeling, and architecture.
- **2. Quality-First & Empirical Mindset:**
 - Internalize testing (black-box, white-box), CI/CD, and experiments.
- **3. Responsible & Rigorous AI Integration:**
 - Steer AI coding agents, validate generated code, and mitigate technical debt.
- **4. Scholarly & Professional Communication:**
 - Deconstruct peer-reviewed literature, run panels, and deliver post-mortems.

Curriculum Roadmap: Five Core Modules

- Module 1: Foundations (Week 1) — 1968 Software Crisis to Modern SE.
- Module 2: Processes & Requirements (Weeks 2–4) — Agile, Scrum, DevOps, Spec-Driven AI.
- Module 3: Design & Modeling (Weeks 5–9) — SOLID, Patterns, UML, Architecture, Midterm.
- Module 4: QA & Testing (Weeks 10–13) — Black/white box, coverage, quality models.
- Module 5: Empirical SE & Capstone (Weeks 14–16) — Controlled experiments, demos & panels.

⚠ Week 3 (09/28) & Week 7 (10/26): National Holidays (No class)

Grading Scheme

- **25% — Midterm Exam (Nov. 2nd)**
 - Part I Evaluation (Core principles & software design)
- **25% — Final Exam (Dec. 7th)**
 - Part II Evaluation (Testing, QA models & empirical methods)
- **20% — Attendance & In-Class Engagement**
 - Active presence, live CCQ polling, discussions & Q&A
- **30% — Final Capstone Project**
 - Execution of Track 1 (Panel), Track 2 (Prototype), or Track 3 (Experiment)

Final Capstone Project: Three Flexible Tracks

- **Team Collaboration:** Teams of 2~4 members (presentation time: ~25 min/person).
- **Track 1: Academic Paper Panel Discussion**
 - Unified theme panel presenting top papers (*ICSE*, *FSE*, *ASE*, *TSE*, *TOSEM*).
 - Student moderator synthesizes trade-offs and leads audience Q&A.
- **Track 2: Software System Prototype & Post-Mortem**
 - Live vertical-slice demo + in-depth SE post-mortem (Clean Architecture, CI/CD).
- **Track 3: Empirical Software Engineering Experiment**
 - Scientific benchmark (RQ_1 , RQ_2), statistical telemetry, and replication package.

Track 1: Academic Paper Panel — How It Works

- **What is an Academic Paper Panel?**
 - Similar to paper presentations, but with a **unified theme and strong narrative coherence**.
 - Four panelists present four related papers (*ICSE*, *FSE*, *ASE*, *TSE*, *TOSEM*).
 - A **Student Moderator** opens with a theme overview, connects the presentations, provides a final synthesis, and leads audience Q&A.
- **Theme Example: "Security & Trust in Generative AI Code Assistants"**
 - **Moderator Intro:** Why AI code security matters to enterprise systems.
 - **Panelist 1 (*ICSE*):** Prevalence and taxonomy of CWE flaws in Copilot code.
 - **Panelist 2 (*FSE*):** Automated hallucination detection in generated tests.
 - **Panelist 3 (*ASE*):** Developer over-reliance & cognitive bias in AI code reviews.
 - **Panelist 4 (*TOSEM*):** Code licensing contamination and privacy leakages.
 - **Moderator Synthesis & Q&A:** Synthesizing trade-offs and moderating class debate.

Track 1: Academic Paper Panel — Visual Setup & Flow



Track 2: System Prototype & Post-Mortem — Examples

- **System Example: "Smart Food Ordering & Real-Time Delivery Service"**
 - **Thin Vertical Slice:**
 - Customer cart & order placement → Real-time kitchen dispatch webhook → Driver location tracking simulation → Order fulfillment status (secondary billing, reviews, and catalog mocked).
 - **Engineering Rigor:**
 - **Clean Architecture:** Strict separation between Domain entities, Use Cases, and Web/DB adapters.
 - **Event-Driven & Async:** Message queues for order events, schema validation with Pydantic/Zod.
 - **Automated CI/CD & Testing:** Dockerized testing environment with >85% unit and integration test coverage.
 - **SE Post-Mortem Presentation:**
 - Live vertical-slice demo, followed by an in-depth engineering post-mortem:
 - Concurrency bottlenecks, AI coding logs, prompt reproducibility, and architectural trade-offs.

Track 3: Empirical SE Experiment — Examples

- **Study Example A: "Benchmarking Open-Source vs. Commercial Coding LLMs"**
 - **Objective:** Controlled benchmark evaluating code correctness and security across models.
 - **Research Questions:**
 - RQ_1 : Do open-source models (e.g., DeepSeek-Coder, Llama-Code) inject higher rates of CWE flaws than GPT-4o on HumanEval-Security?
 - RQ_2 : How does test-driven iterative prompting affect pass@k accuracy and token costs?
 - **Deliverables:** Curated benchmark datasets, automated evaluation scripts, and replication Docker repo.
- **Study Example B: "Empirical Evaluation of Automated Program Repair (APR) in CI"**
 - **Objective:** Measure real-world patch correctness vs. plausible test-overfitting across APR tools.
 - **Research Questions:**
 - RQ_1 : What percentage of LLM-generated bug fixes are semantically sound vs. merely overfitting?
 - RQ_2 : How does token context window depth impact multi-file bug repair success?
 - **Deliverables:** Defects4J benchmark replication suite, execution telemetry logs, and threat analysis.

Academic Integrity & Generative AI Policy

- **Generative AI is Welcomed, but Must Be Steered Responsibly:**
 - Actively leverage modern AI tools (Claude, Cursor, ChatGPT, Copilot).
- **Rule of Transparency:**
 - Document where and how AI was utilized (prompts, edits, test generation).
- **The "Accountability" Rule:**
 - **You are 100% responsible** for correctness, security, and architectural integrity.
 - Blindly accepting hallucinated code or fabricated citations results in severe penalties.
- **Strict Prohibition of Plagiarism:**
 - Uncredited copying of external code, text, or papers is strictly prohibited.

References & Recommended Resources

Core Academic References

- Ian Sommerville, *Software Engineering*, 10th Ed. (Pearson)
- Robert C. Martin, *Clean Architecture* (Prentice Hall)
- Selected research papers from *ACM/IEEE ICSE, IEEE TSE, ACM TOSEM*

Digital Toolchains

- Version Control & CI/CD: GitHub, GitHub Actions, Docker.
- Interactive Polling: NickEduPocket CCQ System ([nickedupocket](https://nickedupocket.com)).
- Slide Engine: Marp Markdown Slide Engine.

Course Materials Architecture & Progressive Evolution

- **Three-Pillar Learning Materials Architecture:**
 - **1. In-Depth Lecture Notes:** Markdown & A4 PDFs for foundational rigor and deep dives.
 - **2. 16:9 Visual Slide Decks:** High-level conceptual diagrams and classroom flow.
 - **3. Real-Time Interactive CCQs:** Micro-assessments with instant mobile QR polling.
- **Human-in-the-Loop AI Collaboration:**
 - Pedagogical design led by instructor; AI assists with scenario synthesis and bilingual polishing.
- **Progressive Updates: Materials are updated weekly alongside class pacing.**

Getting Started & Action Items for Week 1

- **Immediate Next Steps:**
 - 1. Review the Three Capstone Tracks (Panel, Prototype, Experiment).
 - 2. Brainstorm topics and start reaching out to teammates (teams of ~4).
 - 3. Bring your laptop/mobile device to class for interactive CCQ polls.
- **Course Inquiries & Office Hours:**
 - **Instructor:** Prof. Nien-Lin Hsueh (薛念林 教授)
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 - **Contact:** Via course LMS or email

Questions & Discussion

Welcome to Advanced Software Engineering!

Let's build reliable, elegant, and impactful software systems together.